

Recall that, according to the principles of specificity and transfer (**Chapter 4: Foundations of Physical Training**), training is more effective when the training conditions most closely mimic the performance conditions. Therefore, each of the above characteristics should be considered, and the training adjusted appropriately, to prepare the boulderer to perform at her very highest level. In many cases, training exercises can be easily modified to increase specificity. Such modifications include selecting comparable hold types, training intensities, rep and set durations, duty cycles, and movement skills.

TRAINING VARIATIONS FOR BOULDERING

There are two primary differences between the physical demands of bouldering and roped route climbing. Bouldering requires maximum power, due to the intense and dynamic nature of the movement, and minimal endurance, due to the brief nature of most problems. (One exception: Training for long bouldering traverses should mimic training for routes of a

similar length.) While roped climbing typically calls for a balance between these two somewhat mutually exclusive attributes, bouldering typically does not. For boulderers, this simplifies matters tremendously. If not for the importance of skill development (which is emphasized during Base-Fitness training), a climber who boulders exclusively could eliminate most forms of endurance training.

On the other hand, the importance in bouldering of strength, power, and dynamic movement calls for greater emphasis on strength and power training. Furthermore, any training activities that interfere with the cultivation of power should be reduced or eliminated, such as long-duration, low-intensity climbing. The suggested Seasonal Training Plan shown on the next page employs the following bouldering-specific adjustments:

- Shortened Base-Fitness Phase
- Bouldering-specific Outdoor Mileage workouts added
- Optional ARC workouts eliminated
- Power-Endurance Phase eliminated
- Power-specific training extended through the Performance Phase
- Shortened Performance Phase



Bouldering emphasizes dynamic movement, and often involves the use of unusual holds like slopers. Chuck Fryberger, Baja Norte, Mexico. © Andrew Burr

Base
Strength Phase
Power Phase
Performance
Rest

Week	Sunday	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
-	Last Week of Performance Phase of Previous Season						
-	Rest Phase of Previous Season						
-							*Outdoor Mileage (OM), 20+ M probs *Skill acquisition
1	*OM, 10+ moderate problems *Skill acquisition	*Optional Aerobic Exercise (OAE)	*ARC 1: 2 x 30 min *Skill acquisition	*OAE	*ARC 2: 2 x 30 min *Skill practice	*OAE	*Hangboard (HB) 1 *Supplemental Ex
2	*CAE *Skin care	*OAE	*HB 2 *SE	*OAE *Skin care	*OAE	*HB3 *SE	*OAE *Skin care
3	*CAE	*HB 4 *SE	*OAE *Skin care	*OAE	*HB5 *SE	*OAE *Skin care	*OAE
4	*HB6 *SE	*Skin care	*OAE	*HB7 *SE	*Begin Tapering *Skin care		*HB8 *SE
5	*Skin care		*HB9 *SE	*Skin care		*HB10 *SE	*Skin care
6		*Warmup Boulder Ladder (WBL) 60m *Campus 25m; SE	*Skin Care		*Limit Boulder (LB) 120 min *SE	*Skin Care	*WBL 60 min *Campus 30 min *SE
7	*Skin Care		*LB 120 min *SE	*Skin Care	*WBL 60 min *Campus 35 min *SE	*Skin Care	*LB Outdoors
8	*Skin Care	*WBL 60 min *Campus 40 min *SE	*Skin Care		*LB 120 min *SE	*Skin Care	*LB Outdoors
9	*Boulder Attempts *OM, 5 mod problems	*Skin Care		*WBL 60 min *Campus 45 min *SE	*Skin Care		*Boulder Attempts *OM, 5 mod problems
10	*Boulder Attempts *OM, 5 mod problems	*Skin Care		*WBL 60 min *Campus 45 min *SE	*Skin Care		*Boulder Attempts *OM, 5 mod problems
11	*Boulder Attempts *OM, 3 mod problems	*Skin Care		*WBL 60 min *Campus 45 min *SE	*Skin Care		*Boulder Attempts *OM, 5 mod problems
12	*Boulder Attempts *OM, 3 mod problems	*Skin Care		*WBL 60 min	*Skin Care		*Boulder Attempts *OM, 5 mod problems
13		*OAE and/or OCT		*OAE and/or OCT		*OAE and/or OCT	First Day of Next Season

Key:

ARC - Aerobic Restoration and Capillarity Training

HB - Hangboard Workout

LB - Limit Boulder

M, mod - Moderate

OAE - Optional Aerobic Exercise

OCT - Optional Cross-Training

OM - Outdoor Mileage

SE - Supplemental Exercises

WBL - Warm-Up Boulder Ladder

Seasonal Training Plan for an Advanced Boulderer. This program emphasizes strength and power for bouldering, while purposely avoiding endurance training (which reduces power). The activities for each day are listed in chronological order, but the day's primary emphasis is underlined. This schedule results in a significant Power Peak during the tenth and eleventh weeks of the cycle.

A noteworthy consequence of emphasizing power and excluding endurance is that the resulting performance peak is shortened. The standard route-focused Rock Prodigy training program generates a longer peak because the various fitness components peak at slightly different times — creating a power

peak early in the performance peak, and an endurance peak late in the peak. Route climbers can emphasize powerful but less sustained climbing early in the Performance Phase, and then gradually transition toward less powerful but more sustained routes as their performance evolves throughout the phase.

Bouldering: The Weakness Magnifier

Being short, boulder problems distill difficulty into very few moves. Sometimes a problem boils down to only one move, in essence. If the move in question coincides with your personal strengths, the problem may seem a bit easy for the grade. However, if the move exposes a personal weakness, the problem will feel quite hard or even impossible. Esoteric moves or problems can be humbling, but they also provide the rare opportunity to confront a weakness head-on.

The legendary Southern bouldering mecca of Horse Pens 40 is a great example. Many of the problems at Horse Pens consist of very slopy holds used in compression and opposition. This climbing style is almost never encountered elsewhere, let alone on routes. When I first climbed there, I was captivated by the setting, but bewildered by the climbing style. I was tempted to drive the two hours north to Little Rock City, a crimpier area that suited my technical style, but instead I accepted the opportunity to explore a potential weakness. I revised my expectations and replaced my V-grade-focused goals with the resolution to learn this unique climbing style.

I'm still no sultan of slopers, but since that first trip I have vastly improved my skills on friction, compression, and tenuous mantles. When you stumble upon a problem (or in my case, an entire climbing area) that seems outrageously difficult, be humble; consider that the issue might be your own lack of skills (not the "blankety-blank guidebook author"), and then take the opportunity to learn something new — and improve.

— Mike Anderson



Horse Pens 40, AL - Sloper Heaven! Dan Brayack spanking *Bum Boy*, V5. Dan Brayack

For those emphasizing strictly power, it makes little sense to extend the Performance Phase once the power peak has waned. The result is a shortened Performance Phase; however, the power peak experienced with this bouldering-focused plan will last substantially longer than the power peak produced by a route-focused plan. This is because the additional high-intensity bouldering activities prescribed throughout the Performance Phase will sustain the power peak. Also note that there is little practical difference between the latter weeks of the Power Phase and the Performance Phase, so goal boulder problems can and should be attempted at any time during weeks seven through 12. Keep these factors in mind when scheduling road trips or otherwise deciding when to attempt goal boulder problems.

In addition to the adjustments to the Seasonal Training Plan described above, consider these additional training adjustments:

- Add sloper and/or pinch grips to strength-training routines if you're not already using these grips. Pockets are unusual for boulder problems, so depending on your goals, these grips can be de-emphasized.
- During finger-strength training, consider using shorter repetitions, longer rest between repetitions, and fewer repetitions per set. These adjustments will make hangboard training more specific to bouldering. An example of such a routine is provided in the "Max-Recruitment Training with a Hangboard" sidebar found in [Chapter 7: Power](#).
- Emphasize dynamic movement while training, including during indoor bouldering and Campus Board training.
- Supplemental exercises should receive extra attention, particularly exercises that train shoulder, upper arm, and core strength. Lock-off laps and other exercises targeting muscular endurance can be reduced.

AROUSAL

Bouldering demands the very highest level of intensity. Often a problem right at a climber's limit will require 100 percent effort merely to complete a single move. However, applying every ounce of determination and will to each attempt is not a simple matter. The key to unleashing maximum effort is *arousal*. Arousal is a psychological state of alertness and readiness to react to challenging situations. It is a primary driver in the

"Lately, I have given 100 percent for every try I take... no half-assing anything... The only way that I can try hard is if I am pushed to try hard, and this comes from self-motivation."

— Daniel Woods¹

"fight-or-flight" response common to all creatures. High arousal increases muscular tension and focus (among other effects), making it an essential tool for motivating athletic performance¹⁰.

The *Yerkes-Dobson Law* states that arousal directly affects performance, and each person has an ideal level of arousal for the performance of different tasks. Intellectual tasks that depend on high amounts of concentration and receptiveness (such as delicate slab or technical endurance climbing) require relaxation and low arousal⁵. Tasks that depend on tremendous physical strength and narrow focus (like powerful bouldering) require high arousal, which explains why grunts and even screams regularly escape from bouldering caves. Aside from the spectacle, such brutish behavior can actually improve performance. Optimal arousal levels vary from person to person, so note the levels of personal arousal that produce the best results in each situation⁸.

Chemicals in the brain called neurotransmitters regulate a person's arousal level, but arousal can also be influenced externally. Learning to manipulate this command pathway can allow an athlete to regularly unleash tremendous power. Several methods for increasing arousal include:

- Listening to upbeat music
- Visualizing the ensuing performance
- Physical activity
- Vocal encouragement from spectators
- Positive self-talk
- Reviewing performance goals

These influences will have a different effect on each climber's arousal level, so experiment with each to find an effective combination. Whatever the combo, apply more energy and zeal to these activities to achieve a higher state of arousal. Competitive athletes in power sports (and even some boulderers) often find it helpful to yell encouragement to themselves, flex their muscles, jump up and down, or even slap themselves in the face to achieve the highest state of arousal. It is possible to overdo it, however. An Incredible Hulk-like state of maniacal rage will impair technical abilities and judgment.

GET AMPED!!!

"When you do hard routes, you have to try hard. They're not easy routes. You have to give everything you have. You have to get totally animalistic.... It's like martial arts. When Bruce Lee threw a punch, he had to mean it. Haahhh! Like that. When you're doing a hard move, there is this excess energy you have to let out. Air explodes out of you." — Chris Sharma³

I'm known as a very reserved, unemotional person. However, that personality, and its accompanying low level of arousal, is not ideal for bouldering. I'm unlikely to access the very zenith of my physical potential while remaining calm. It's a biological fact that all of us are stronger and faster when we're "crazy," and there are many examples of regular folks conjuring superhuman strength in life-or-death situations.

To access this fight-or-flight state for the hardest moves, you must manufacture an adrenaline surge. I do it by subtly and momentarily getting angry. This is a far cry from my typical demeanor, and very different from the appropriate arousal for route climbing; therefore, it's not easy. I might think of something that bugs me (like starving children in Africa or my boss tasking me on Friday afternoon), then I exhale rapidly, grit my teeth, and "growl" or grunt quietly. In the moment of the move, I might even scream.

Don't be ashamed to use these techniques. It may sound ridiculous, and many climbers think they are above such antics, but this is a *technique* for improving climbing performance just like other more physical tools such as hand jams or drop-knees. It has been used in the martial arts for centuries to access greater power, and new trainees are coached to scream "Kia!" with every blow in practice. Considering that martial arts involves an opponent literally trying to pummel you, it hardly seems necessary to artificially amplify arousal! Absent an impending physical beating, climbers must be much more deliberate to reach an equivalent state of arousal, so don't be afraid to go ballistic, unleash your *GRRR face*, and get amped!!! — Mike Anderson



Bouldering demands high intensity and arousal. Melissa Lipani sticks *Bu Shi*, V5, Fry Canyon Boulders, UT.

 Andrew Burr

Once on the problem, extremely high intensity should be maintained throughout the ascent. Boulder problems do not require the steady, efficient movement that facilitates successful route climbing, because accumulating fatigue is rarely limiting in bouldering. Therefore, don't be afraid to go all out on every move. Often climbers who excel on routes struggle with boulders because they have trained themselves to climb within their limits in order to ration their energy for a redpoint. While this approach is critical for route climbing, it can be detrimental on a limiting boulder problem, leading the climber to fidget in search of comfort after each move, when maintaining upward momentum would be more prudent. Give each attempt maximum effort until you fall — don't jump off voluntarily because you botched a sequence or a handhold doesn't feel perfect. As long as you are still clinging to the boulder, there is still a fighting chance, so keep fighting.

Bouldering can be as much about "letting go" as holding on — letting go of your control over the situation. Many climbers have "wobbled" their way up extreme boulders, just barely latching each move with wild desperation. This state is sometimes referred to as "going squid;" perhaps bungling sequences, flailing haphazardly, but inconceivably sticking just enough to make the next unlikely move. This style may seem careless, but it defines some of the best boulderers in history.

Influence your arousal prior to attempting a limiting boulder problem, and then once in "battle mode", give each move every ounce of your effort. There are no style points, and there is no looming crux to conserve energy for. If necessary, think of yourself as falling upward, using your commitment and momentum to stick moves you never would otherwise. If you never let go, this intensity has the power to carry you to the top.

"I love the feeling of getting shut down, then discovering subtle tricks that make the problem possible. The test is seeing how small of a hold the body can pull down on or how crazy of a position you can put yourself into."

— Daniel Woods¹

STRATEGY AND TACTICS

The convenience of bouldering, and the often playground-like venues involved, tends to discourage in-depth planning. Meanwhile, the necessary high density of difficult movements can take quite a toll on the body, both in terms of the pulling muscles and joints but also key junctures in your lower body, like feet, ankles, and knees, which must absorb the shock of each fall to the ground. Fortunately, sound strategy and tactics can help ensure optimal, injury-free performance out on the blocks just as it does with other styles of climbing. Here are some approaches to make bouldering more efficient and productive:

SAFETY FIRST

Many neophytes assume bouldering is relatively safe since the climber is never very far off the ground. In fact, bouldering is the most dangerous form of climbing in terms of injuries per participant. Boulderers hit the ground every time they fall, and these countless impacts result in many injuries, to every body part imaginable. Furthermore, even those falls that don't cause acute trauma can cause debilitating repetitive-stress injuries over the years, including permanent arthritis. A climber can't perform if he is injured, but equally important, he can't commit to difficult moves if he's scared. To perform optimally, boulderers need a reassuring spot and a tall stack of crashpads, so join up with a good-sized crew and take advantage of their strength in numbers. Bouldering in large groups also has many other advantages, including the free flow of beta and plentiful encouragement.

Before attempting a problem, assess the landing zone carefully. Remove any rocks, logs, or other obstacles — in accordance with the landowner's policies, and with consideration for other visitors and the environment. Consider where the climber might roll if she loses her balance when she lands. Arrange the pads tightly, so there are no gaps between pads. If possible, stack multiple layers of pads, and overlap any seams or soft spots in the padding. If not making a flash attempt, take a few practice falls from low on the problem to ensure that the pads are properly aligned. Inspect the descent before starting up the problem, or use it as a warm-up if possible.

Have a spotter (or several) positioned to guide the climber to the crashpad in the event of a fall. The spotter's job is primarily to redirect the climber's center of mass (near the hips) to a safe landing zone, but



Establishing a safe environment is essential for facilitating complete commitment. Jimmy Webb feeling secure on the *Dune Arête* (V9), Hueco Tanks, TX.  Dan Brayack

also to ensure that the head and neck do not contact the ground (especially critical on steeply overhanging or horizontal terrain). The spotter should not attempt to “catch” a falling climber.

WORKING A PROBLEM

From a technical perspective, working a problem is much like working a route crux, though the tactics used are much different. In bouldering, it's usually necessary to climb up to each move before trying various options, and it may not be possible to thoroughly feel each hold (a consequence of not having a rope or fixed protection points). This is rooted in tradition and style. Historically boulderers have embraced the *ground-up* ethic, and eschewed aids like top rope inspection. However, these former taboos are rapidly fading. For example, a stepladder was famously used to facilitate the second ascent of *The Mandala*, a classic V12 in the Buttermilks². Consider the advice of John Gill:

“When I did most of my bouldering, in the late 1950s through the 1970s, I used top ropes sometimes and at other times avoided any type of protection. Top roping was acceptable for most climbers who bouldered — until the relatively recent introduction of pads... Don't be reluctant to put on a rope if you think you may come off from more than a few feet above the ground — thirty or forty years from now your back, knees, ankles, and feet will thank you.”⁶

With this in mind, consider every practical option when struggling to unlock a challenging problem. Take a few steps back from the boulder and examine the problem from various angles, to evaluate each hold as well as potential sequence options. Stack pads, use a power spot, or get a boost from your partner to inspect each hold and attempt individual moves. Use the descent route to reach the top of the boulder in order to examine and clean potential finishing holds. It may even be possible to downclimb a few moves to inspect crux holds from another point of view. Considering the effort it requires simply to *arrive* at the crux on many problems, good pacing is essential. If working a problem in a group, skip a turn every now and then and let others put their energy and enthusiasm (and skin!) into unlocking the sequence. Visualize all possible sequence options before wasting an attempt on a dead end. Whenever possible, seek beta from others or on the Web to save precious energy for more attempts.

The P-Spot

It can be quite frustrating to learn a limit move: It's often a binary proposition in which the move either seems to be very clearly climbable or very much not so! In other words, there is no way to ease into such a move or to learn it progressively. In fact, limit moves *can* be attempted progressively with a *power spot*, a critical tool for advancing on the hardest boulder problems. With a power spot, the spotter places his hands on the climber just above the hips and removes weight as the climber moves. The spotter should press upward, against gravity, not into the rock, and should attempt to permit the climber to move naturally in the case of dynamic moves. The spotter should provide as much assistance as necessary for the climber to complete the move, with said assistance reduced progressively over subsequent attempts as the climber imprints the move. Implemented in this way, the power spot provides a means for slowly but surely learning to complete moves that otherwise feel impossible.

Power spotting is as old as bouldering. While some look down on it, myriad bouldering legends have used the technique throughout the decades. A case in point is Jerry Moffatt's first ascent of *The Dominator* in Yosemite's Camp 4, one of the world's first V13s. As described in his autobiography *Revelations*, Moffatt used a power spot from Kurt Albert while working out the crux moves:

“I had to see if I could hold these features and support my weight. I got Kurt to help me. He was six foot two of solid German muscle, so he would pick me up and hold me onto the rock while I figured out the positions... With that, Kurt would release me and I would struggle to keep my body in contact with the rock for a moment before falling off... In this way, I worked right along the boulder, trying various ways of getting to this hold.”⁹

Finally, when trying to learn the moves on a new problem, it's easy to climb too much and rest too little — spurred on by your enthusiasm for the novel moves and the deceiving feeling that you've *almost* stuck it. Don't fall into this trap; when working a hard problem — or going for the send — patience is vital. Rest at least five minutes between each attempt. Take a longer break after five or so good attempts. Slip on a pair of tennis shoes and go for a short walk, eat a snack,

and drink some water. Frantically hammering away on a single problem again and again will only hasten fatigue and frustration.

BRUSHING

Bouldering often involves the use of big slopers or other friction-dependent holds. For this reason, the stone must be clean and free of any loose dirt, chalk, or other debris. Brush holds regularly (between each attempt) when friction is a factor. Consider mounting a toothbrush to the end of an extendable pole to brush out-of-reach holds. Different brushes may be preferable for various tasks. Lapis horse or boar's-hair brushes are ideal for cleaning the rock without polishing it. Large soft-bristled nylon brushes should be used for big slopers, and stiff-bristled brushes like the Metolius M16 should be used for tiny holds on harder metamorphic rock types like granite. Finicky climbers can also attach a blow tube, allowing them to blow on distant holds.

The same applies to shoes, hands, and crash-pads. It's easy to dirty shoes while bouldering, so brush or wipe them off before each attempt. Start

each problem by stepping off a pad to keep shoes clean, or use a small section of tarp or carpet if pads are limited. Keep the pads clean by regularly lifting them up and shaking off loose debris. Keep hands clean, and wipe away any excess chalk before starting up, to avoid caking the holds.

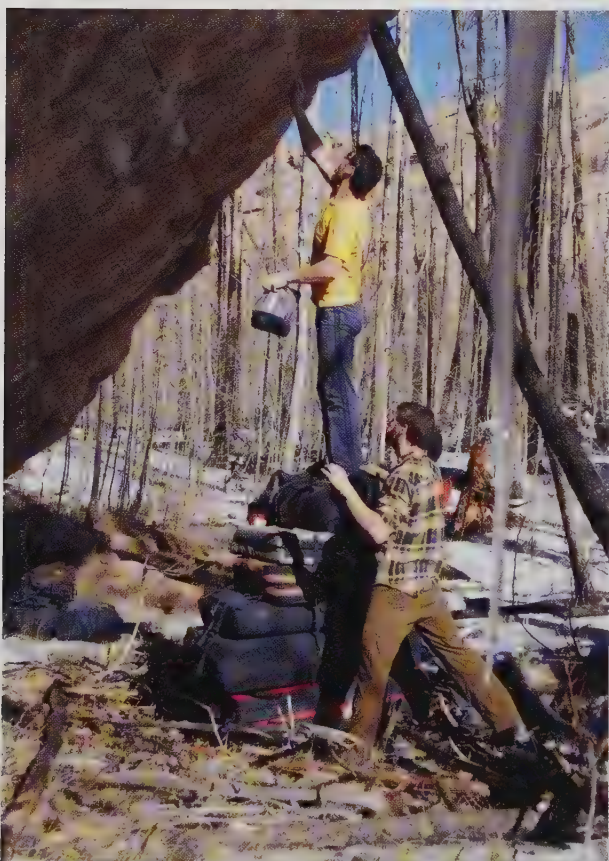
SKIN MANAGEMENT

Since bouldering is akin to climbing crux-like moves over and over, it's easy to quickly wreck your finger skin. As always, prevention is far more effective than treatment. Pace bouldering efforts throughout the day and examine your finger pads between each attempt. Tape sensitive areas preemptively to avoid skin injuries. Be cognizant of any sharp or irregular hand-holds, and avoid attempting such moves too frequently. It's best to attempt particularly sharp problems on colder days, when the skin is hard and resilient. Rest frequently, and allow the skin to cool and dry between each attempt. Bring a skin-care kit to the blocks and use it as needed. Details on skin care are provided in [Chapter 9: Rest, Injury Prevention, and Rehabilitation](#).

PACING AND VARIETY

Adequate rest is necessary to generate maximum power. Rest at least a good five minutes between attempts, and avoid the urge to jump back on a problem immediately after an unexpected fall. Consider the rest intervals used in the Power Phase of training (between Campus Board sets, for example), and apply that pacing to performance-bouldering sessions. A duty cycle of 1:20 is perfectly reasonable (i.e., for a 15-second effort you'd allow five minutes of rest). Wear a jacket or sweater between attempts to stay warm — the simple act of donning and removing clothing and shoes between attempts can help slow the pace of a bouldering session. Consider the beta and the quality of the previous attempt during each rest period. Analyze what worked and what didn't and consider alternate sequences. Take frequent breaks throughout each session, and take several long breaks during the day.

One pacing strategy is to equate the bouldering day to a route-climbing day, where each effort to solve a problem is equivalent to a route attempt. Spend 45 to 60 minutes unlocking the moves, taking minutes to rest between each "knowledge burn." Then take an extended break after you send the problem or the hour is up, whichever comes first. Use this time to have a snack or watch other climbers, or move on to another boulder if you failed to send your project. A



Consider creative ways to inspect out-of-reach holds. Jon Glassberg feels the grips on *Defying Gravity*, V15, in the South Platte, CO while Rich Crowder and Rob D'Anastasio support. Jason Haas

single problem should not be worked for longer than an hour — including rest breaks — at a time, lest you risk injury.

Another way to prolong a bouldering session is to vary the route style. For example, spend some time on pocket problems, transition to crimpy problems, and then finish on open-hand sloper problems. Vary steepness as well. Steeper routes will emphasize physical strength and large muscle groups, whereas vertical or slabby routes will emphasize footwork and finger strength.

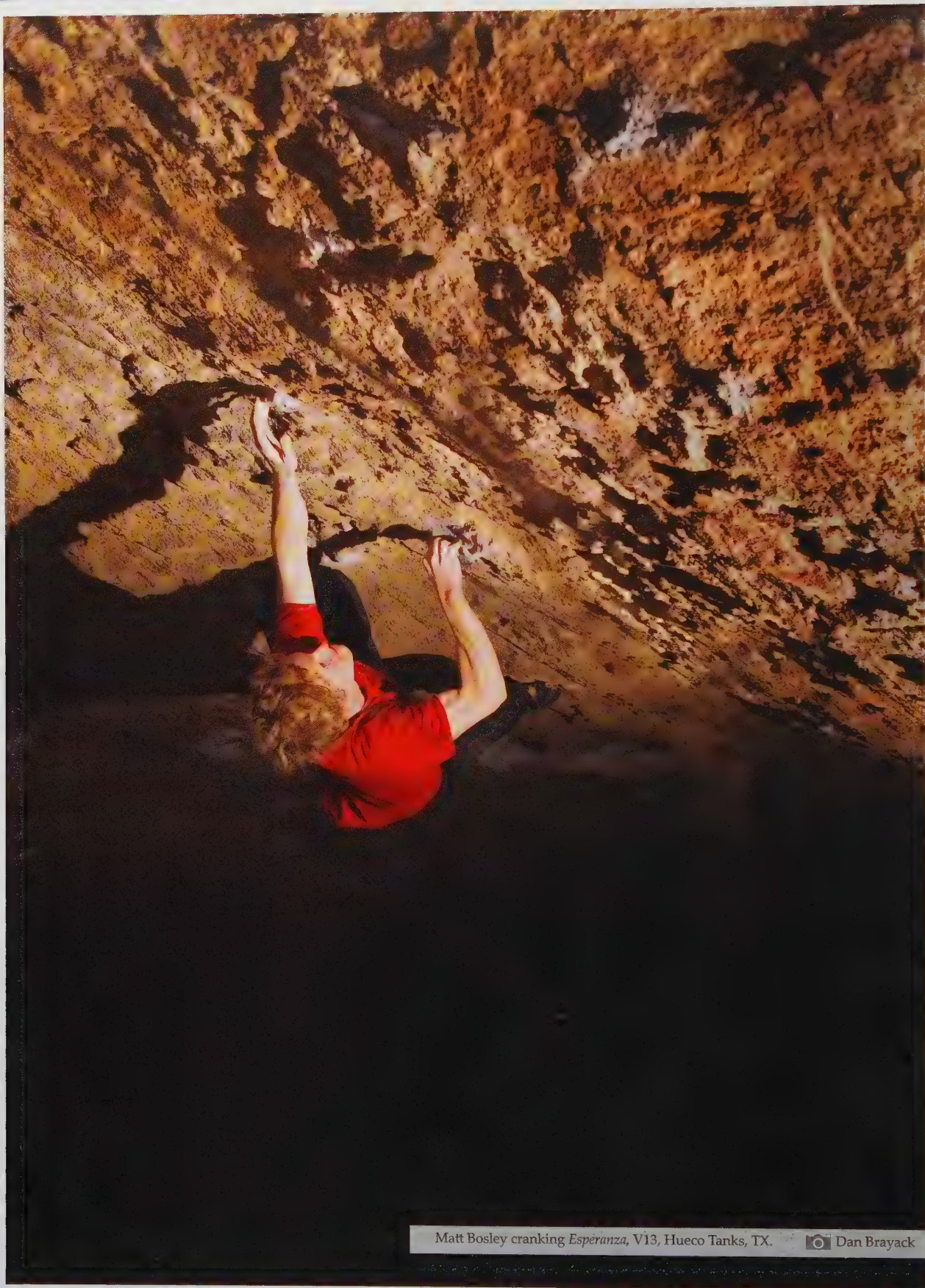
GRADES

It's easy to get hung up on numbers, regardless of climbing style. However, bouldering grades are even more subjective than route grades, since strengths and weaknesses tend to average out over a greater number of moves. A problem's difficulty often depends on the physical characteristics of the climber, like height and reach, so take grades with a grain of salt, and take pleasure in the quality and novelty of the movement whatever the rating.



Savoring the experience on *So High*, V5 R, Joshua Tree.

 Brendan Nicholson



Matt Bosley cranking *Esperanza*, V13, Hueco Tanks, TX.  Dan Brayack

Flashing a Problem

Sending a problem on the first attempt is the most prized style of ascent. In route climbing, first-try sends are distinguished between *onsights* (where the climber has little to no prior knowledge of the route) and *flashes* (where the climber receives *beta* by watching or talking to other climbers). While the definitions are constantly evolving and open to personal interpretation, boulderers generally do not make this distinction⁴. Every first-try ascent in bouldering is called a “flash,” whether external beta was used or not. Furthermore, the consensus among leading pebble wrestlers is that groping any holds within reach of the ground does not invalidate a flash⁴. The point being, when bouldering get all the beta you can before a flash attempt.

To begin, video of most well-known problems is available online, so do a little research beforehand. Then visit the area on a busy day, when you can observe several other climbers on the problem, and discuss the intricacies of the beta with them: how to grasp each hold, where to position hips, and key footholds. Place special emphasis on learning which features to aim for when making dynamic moves — the hardest moves to flash. Attempt the problem after a thorough warm-up that includes working a few harder problems. Wait until a plethora of pads and spotters are available so you can climb with complete confidence and commitment. Flashing at your limit requires an aggressive attitude, so get fired up before your attempt, and ask your spotters to shout encouragement.

SUMMARY

- Bouldering differs from route climbing in a number of key ways, including: length, intensity, movement, arousal, hold type, exposure, style, group size, accessibility, conditions, and duty cycle.
- Training can be tailored to maximize bouldering performance, but doing so may temporarily hamper route-climbing performance (i.e., reduce endurance).
- To emphasize bouldering performance, minimize Base-Fitness training while maximizing Strength and Power training. Train on representative hold types, such as slopers, pinches, and crimps.
- Emphasize dynamic movements in skill development and training. Place extra emphasis on core, upper-arm, and shoulder strength training.
- Bouldering benefits from high arousal. Learn how to influence arousal and practice these methods regularly.
- Ensure a safe bouldering environment in order to stay healthy and apply maximum commitment to each attempt.
- Be creative when attempting to unlock sequences. Get different perspectives and watch other climbers.
- Pace your efforts throughout each session, and vary the style of climbing to prolong bouldering sessions.
- Monitor your skin, and address any potential issues preemptively. Keep holds, shoes, and hands clean.
- Bouldering grades are especially inconsistent, so avoid fixating on them. Instead, focus on the opportunity to develop as a climber.